



FIREDIES | STREAM DECK SERIES



NOW PLAYING

OWNER'S MANUAL

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FIREDIES PRODUCTIONS · OXFORD · FD-2026-NP-V1.0

Whatever's playing. Wherever it's playing.

Album art, the track, the artist and a live progress bar—on a key, for Spotify, Apple Music, a YouTube tab, foobar2000, anything. There's no account to connect and no player to choose, because it doesn't talk to any of them.

It reads **Windows' own media session**—the same place the volume popup gets its track name. If Windows knows what's playing, so does the key.

02 QUICK START

1. Drag **Now Playing** (under **Now Playing**) onto any key or dial.
 2. Play something. The key fills in by itself.
 3. That's the setup. Everything after this is taste.
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03 THE COLOUR IS THE COVER

The accent is sampled from the album artwork itself, so the key changes character with every track—and it's contrast-checked, so the text stays readable whether the cover is a white sleeve or a black one.

If you'd rather it held still: **Always blue** keeps the Firedies accent whatever is playing, and **Custom** lets you set your own gradient and keep it.

04 WHEN NOTHING IS PLAYING

The key says **QUIET**, and a dial says **NOTHING PLAYING**. It doesn't keep the last track up as though it were still going, and it doesn't leave a progress bar frozen mid-song pretending to be live.

That's deliberate, and it's the rule the whole family is built on: **a face that can't know something says so**. A key that shows yesterday's track is worse than a key that shows nothing, because you'll believe it.

05 THREE LOOKS

Full	Artwork, track and the progress bar—plus the artist, one tick away in the panel (it is on by default on a dial, off on a key, because a key is small).
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Artwork only	The cover, edge to edge. A wall of these is genuinely lovely.
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Just the icon	A single play mark in the accent colour and nothing else, for a deck that already has enough going on.
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Plus **zoom** and a **background darkness** control for the artwork look, so the blurred glow behind the cover sits back where you want it.

06 THE CONTROLS

Press the key	Play or pause.
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Hold the key	Next track—or switch between the full and artwork looks, whichever you set it to.
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Tap the dial	Play or pause.
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Turn the dial	Skips tracks. In scrub mode it seeks; in volume mode it moves the system volume.
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Long-press the dial	Cycles it: skip, then scrub, then volume, then back. Hold about 1.5 seconds to jump straight to volume.
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One dial, three jobs—skip, scrub, volume. Scrubbing turns the elapsed time to the accent colour and puts a handle on the bar; volume shows a speaker and a percentage.

07 WHICH PLAYERS

By default it shows whatever is playing. If your browser and your music app fight over the key, you can list **only these** players, or **hide these**—so a YouTube tab in the background never steals the face from the album you're actually listening to.

It tells you, rather than pretending.

Not every player publishes everything. Some give Windows a track name but no timeline; some accept play and pause but refuse to be sought. When that happens the dial names which it is—**NO TIMELINE FROM THIS APP**, or **THIS APP WON'T SEEK**—and hands you the volume instead, rather than leaving the long-press looking broken.

foobar2000 is the common case: it reports the track but not the position until you install the free **foo_mediacontrol** component, after which the bar works normally.

09 SOUND AND FEEL

A **tactile click** on press, with its own volume—the default, or a file of your own. It's deliberately separate from the music: the click is feedback for your finger, not part of what you're listening to.

10 HONEST LIMITS

- **We only know what the app tells Windows.** Missing artwork, a blank artist, a stuck timeline—those come from the player, and the key shows what it was given rather than inventing the rest.
 - **Some players never register at all.** If an app doesn't publish a media session, nothing on Windows can see it, including the volume overlay.
 - **Nothing leaves your PC.** No account, no sign-up, no analytics, and not a single network call—the artwork comes from the player, not from the internet.
 - **Windows only, for now.** The media session this reads is a Windows interface.
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Windows 10/11 · Stream Deck 6.5+ · Firedies Productions, Oxford
Docs and support: github.com/FirediesProductions/stream-deck



FIREDIES

PRODUCTIONS

WE RISE. ALWAYS.